

1. sqlite-utils 4.0, now with database schema migrations

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-07T19:32:57+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/7/sqlite-utils-4/#atom-everything>

This morning I released sqlite-utils 4.0, the 124th release of that project and the first major version bump since 3.0 in November 2020. In addition to some small but significant breaking changes (described in this upgrade guide), this version introduces three major features: database migrations, nested transactions (via a new `db.atomic()` method), and support for compound foreign keys. Database schema migrations using sqlite-utils Schema migrations define a sequence of changes to be made to a SQLite database, plus a mechanism for tracking which migrations have been applied and applying any that are found to be pending. Migrations are defined in Python files using the sqlite-utils Python library, which includes a powerful `table.transform()` method providing enhanced alter table capabilities that are not supported by SQLite's ALTER TABLE statement. (`table.transform()` implements the pattern recommended by the SQLite documentation - create a new temporary table with the new schema, copy across the data, then drop the old table and rename the temporary one in its place.) Here's an example migration file which creates a table called creatures, adds an additional column to it in a...

2. sqlite-migrate 0.2

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-07T16:33:55+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/7/sqlite-migrate/#atom-everything>

Release: sqlite-migrate 0.2 The version that retires the library, instead implementing a compatibility shim against the new sqlite-utils 4.0 dependency. Tags: sqlite-utils

3. github-code Web Component

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-07T16:18:16+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/7/github-code-component/#atom-everything>

Tool: github-code Web Component An experimental Web Component built using GPT-5.5 and the following prompt: let's build a Web Component for embedding code from GitHub It takes URLs like that, converts them to https://raw.githubusercontent.com/simonw/sqlite-ast/437c759129154f05296324a7f82aa1246340dd14/sqlite_ast/parser.py, then uses `fetch()` to fetch them and displays the specified range of lines - with line numbers, no syntax highlighting though Show me a preview web browser so I can see your work Here's what it looks like embedded on this page: Tags: github, web-components, gpt

4. Blog about things you don't understand yet

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Tue, 07 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/blog-about-things-you-dont-understand-yet/>

Every post I publish represents at least two things I've learned: the thing that prompted me to write the post, and the thing I learned in the course of writing it. If I don't learn anything new while I'm writing, it's not interesting enough to publish. Typically I learn way more than two things. For instance, in my o3 geoguessr post, I started out with the idea that most AI prompts probably don't work, and I ended up learning that newer OpenAI models have lost o3's ability to geolocate. That's interesting! In my most recent post on C2PA, I started out with the idea that C2PA requires near-universal adoption, but I learned a ton of things about PKI, managing private keys on local devices, how C2PA actually works, and so on. In my post on the Luddites, I started out with the idea that the Luddite movement was fundamentally decentralized, but ended up fascinated by Luddite culture (which was far more elitist, misogynist, and violent than the pop-Luddism books describe). I could do this for every single post on the blog. Taking a position I think the core reason this works is that every single one of my blog posts argues a point. I never publish a post that just gives some scatter...

5. How did Windows 95 decide that a setup program ran?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 07 Jul 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260707-00/?p=112508>

It used some heuristics. The post How did Windows 95 decide that a setup program ran? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

6. OS 27 Developer Beta 3 Enables New ?Pace? and ?Expressivity? Sliders for Siri?s New Voices

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-07T15:22:26Z

Link: <https://techcrunch.com/2026/07/06/you-can-now-customize-siris-pace-and-expressivity-in-the-latest-ios-27-beta/>

Sarah Perez, writing for TechCrunch: With the latest iOS 27 developer beta, Apple is giving testers an early look at one of the upcoming improvements to its AI-powered Siri : the ability to adjust how quickly and expressively the AI assistant speaks. In iOS 27 beta 3, out today, Apple has enabled the voice controls for ?Pace? and ?Expressivity? that were previously labeled as ?Coming soon? in the first developer beta releases. I started running developer beta 1 on a spare iPhone the day it came at WWDC. It proved so stable, and Siri AI so useful, that I moved my primary iPhone 17 Pro to the iOS 27 betas with beta 2. So I?ve more or less been living on iOS 27 developer betas for a month now. If you?re as reckless as me, you?re probably doing so already too. If you?re not, you should probably at least wait for the public betas, the first of which I?ll bet is imminent. The stability of these betas right out of the gate is proof that this really is a Snow Leopard-type fix-and-improve-the-foundations year. I love it. As for the new Siri voices, I think both of the new voices that are available so far are very good. Voice 1 is female and voice 2 is male; I?ve spent days with both but pr...

7. Allen Pike, Back in November: ?Why Is ChatGPT for Mac So Good??

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-06T17:37:05Z

Link: <https://allenpike.com/2025/why-is-chatgpt-so-good-claude/>

Allen Pike, back in November (and corresponding Hacker News thread): Still, I wouldn?t count out the possibility of a change in course here. While mobile is king, desktop is still where work happens. While OpenAI has acquired Sky to double down on desktop, Google has long been all-in on the browser. That leaves Anthropic as the challenger on desktop, with their latest models begging to be paired with well-crafted apps. A few months ago Google launched a native Gemini app for the Mac. A month ago I wrote about why it?s not that great, and annoyingly presumptuous . Almost all good Mac apps are native; not all native Mac apps are good. What keeps me using ChatGPT and keeps me away from using Claude is not that ChatGPT happens to be written using native APIs like AppKit. It?s that it looks and feels like a Mac app ? you know, with a Settings window that is ... a window. And even more so, with very cool features like its ability to attach a chat to an open document in BBEdit or Notes. When ChatGPT is attached to an open document in another app, it?s not a snapshot at the moment of attachment, like what you?d get by copying and pasting the whole thing into the chat, or by dragging the...

8. ATP Member Special: Mac-Assed Mac Apps

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-06T17:13:52Z

Link: <https://atp.fm/atp-dev-mac-assed-mac-apps>

A banger of an Accidental Tech Podcast members-only special, right on time . ATP memberships are just \$8/month or \$88/year, and the members-only episodes alone are worth the price. They do a great job explaining what makes for a Mac-assed Mac app, but an even better job talking about why users and developers should care about them. ?

9. Notes on pulling from multiple upstream Git mirrors

Source: Chris?s Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-07-08T02:38:21Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/programming/GitPullingFromMirrors>

It started with a discovery about my access to the official Emacs repository : This is my face when my home desktop appears to be persistently talking to one instance of <https://git.savannah.gnu.org> that is many days out of date and out of sync on the GNU Emacs git

repository. Yes, I know, volunteer organization, but how do you even troubleshoot that? At this rate I'm going to have to switch to the Github mirror even though the thought makes me spit reflexively. (By 'how do you even troubleshoot that', I meant how might I figure out which mirror is out of date and report it. That DNS name has eight IPv4 addresses and eight IPv6 ones, although you can at least restrict Git to either IPv4 or IPv6.) This led to me wishing for a way to conveniently pull the same branch from two different upstreams . To be specific, the experience I would like looks like this: `$ git status` On branch emacs-31 Your branch is up to date with 'origin/emacs-31'. [...] `$ git pull` [pulls and updates my emacs-31 local checkout from some reliable mirror] `$ git pull savannah` [pulls from the official repository and also updates my emacs-31 local checkout] As was pointed out to me by several people (once I read the...

10. Our mixed building network wiring and its consequences

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-07-07T22:54:40Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/sysadmin/OurMixedBuildingWiring>

In a comment on my entry about how sometimes it's the network that's the problem , I was asked what networking workstations typically have on our networks (and if we still use 100 MBit for low speed things). The simple answer is that it's somewhat mixed but mostly 1G Ethernet, often with 1G uplinks from the switches that the office network jacks are connected to. But there's some stories involved. As a university department, we have been in our current buildings for what is mostly multiple decades, and in some cases since the early 1980s (cf). In the oldest building (with our old machine room), the department's presence predates twisted pair network wiring entirely (there is still disconnected thicknet wiring around our offices); our other most used building predates Cat-6 cabling . As a result, all of this older space is wired with Cat-5 twisted pair and is only good for 1G Ethernet . We started out using all of this wiring at 100 MBit (including our connection to the university backbone), and even as time went by we had a mixture of 100 MBit and 1G switches and connections . Due to cost reasons and sometimes wiring density problems , we only slowly migrated people's office...

11. Content addressing in package managers

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-07-07T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/07/07/content-addressing-in-package-managers.html>

Content addressing identifies a piece of data by a cryptographic hash of its contents rather than by a name or a location. Two copies of the same bytes get the same identifier wherever they came from, a single changed bit produces a completely different one, and because the identifier is derived from the data itself it works as a lookup key and an integrity check at the same time. I keep running into content addressing in package management, usually solving one problem at one layer, and I've been collecting the places it appears. A package manager content-addressed end to end would have its registry index, its package metadata, every released artifact, and the files inside them all named by hash, so any of it could be fetched from any source and verified locally. That idea has been floating around for as long as I've been paying attention, and several of the systems below get a long way towards it without any one of them yet covering the whole stack. This is a survey of the pieces as they exist today: what gets hashed, and what each hash is used for. What gets hashed Individual files within a package. pnpm keeps a shared on-disk store, normally one per filesystem, where every file...

12. I'm just so bored of AI

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Mon, 06 Jul 2026 11:34:18 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/07/im-just-so-bored-of-ai/>

I'm just so bored of talking about AI. It's like listening to vapers tell me how delicious their flavoured poison is. Did you ever meet someone at university who'd just tried drugs for the first time? Listening to a stoner ramble on about their mystic crystal revelations is amusing for the first five minutes, but quickly gets tiresome. Wow! You got your little computer friend to automate calling ?

13. Let AI Burn

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 07 Jul 2026 17:09:10 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/let-ai-burn/>

If you liked this piece, you should subscribe to my premium newsletter. It's \$70 a year, or \$7 a month, and in return you get a weekly newsletter that's usually anywhere from 5,000 to 18,000 words, including vast, detailed analyses of NVIDIA, Anthropic and

14. A full body MRI earns you a year of smoking

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 07 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/full-body-mri-earns-you-a-base-jump>

Alternative titles: ? earns you a high-risk pregnancy ? earns you an ascent of Matterhorn ? earns you 10,000 km on a motorcycle ? earns you two BASE jumps ? earns you a day on the frontline in Ukraine These are all about equivalent to the risk of one year of smoking.

(Continue reading the full article on the web.)

15. Kort geding aandeelhouders Solvinity

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Tue, 07 Jul 2026 11:20:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/kort-geding-aandeelhouder-solvinity/>

Gisteren deed ik op Mastodon live verslag van het kort geding van de aandeelhouders van Solvinity tegen de staatssecretaris van Digitale Economie en Soevereiniteit. Gek genoeg zag ik in de rechtbank dingen die ik later in het nieuws niet of weinig vernam. Pers en media waren in grote getale op komen draven, wat leidde tot de volgende artikelen: AD: Nederlandse overheid wilde bedrijf achter DigiD niet zelf kopen, stelt Solvinity in rechtbank NRC: Met harde woorden vecht Solvinity, het bedrijf achter DigiD, het verbod op verkoop aan een Amerikaans bedrijf aan (kadolink, laat weten als ?ie niet meer werkt) Nu.

16. Pluralistic: How US states and international trustbusters can beat Big Tech (07 Jul 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 07 Jul 2026 12:24:15 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/07/07/going-global/>

Today's links How US states and international trustbusters can beat Big Tech: Their common enemies are Trump and his tech giants. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Sex work synonyms; Carthedral; French pirates; Suffragette surveillance; Hidden library apartments; "The Meaning of July the Fourth for the Negro" x James Earl Jones; Farage quits; Peak indifference; Self publishing; Pepsi spies try to buy Coke formula; Steal this wiki; SF is the only lit people care enough about to steal; HP Lovecraft's commonplace book; "7th Sigma"; Conspiracy fantasy; PalmOS beampoints; Copyright poetry; Abandoned NOLA themepark; Life in Indian call-centers; "Rule 34"; Unpleasant design; WEB du Bois infographics; Drone v South African racism; Escobar's hippos; Brexit nihilism; UK Iraq War inquiry; Copyright reversion; Paperclip traded for house; Pen with shredder; Broadcast Treaty is back; "Influencing Machine"; ANSI x paid sex; Biden x Right to Repair; Technological self-determination. Upcoming appearances: London, Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcomi...